





Photograph by ISHITA SITWALA

A DIVERSE PORTFOLIO

Sonali and her partner remain intimately tethered to the conceptualisation of every single design. For Sonali, the secret to avoiding professional burnout is her uncanny ability to seamlessly switch scales within a single afternoon—a superpower she calls her personal secret sauce. "On the same day, I could be designing a tiny, intimate machan on the edge of the Ranthambore forest and then switch to designing Jaipur Gems, a massive project spread across acres," she says. "I could be looking at a massive river-training landscape infrastructure project and then immediately pivot to designing the Secretariat for the Kingdom of Bhutan. Wearing different scales throughout the day thrills me and because of that thrill, I've become very good at it." With 300 architects constantly asking 'why?' and pushing the envelope, monotony is a foreign concept in her studio.

TRULY ECO CHIC

With increase in demand for bespoke private residences rooted in sustainability, her practice also has a luxury residential arm called Morpho.Homes. "For centuries, people have been incredibly creative about living with climate, whether through central courtyards, thick walls or small windows," says Sonali. That relationship is evolving. Homes seek greenery and a closer connection with nature, while expansive glazing brings the outdoors in. Natural light, ventilation, landscape and local craft shape contemporary spaces, while bespoke materials add individuality. Sonali believes the possibilities are limitless, what matters is how materials are selected, presented and utilised. For her, true luxury lies in comfort and architecture that grows more meaningful with time.

A LIVING LEGACY

When asked about the ultimate legacy she wants to leave behind for the next generation of designers, Sonali pauses, admitting that even after decades of redefining sustainability benchmarks, she still feels like she is just about starting. "However, her vision for the future is less about concrete monuments and more about an attitude toward the craft." My personal legacy would be the habit of walking into work every single day with an unyielding sense of discovery and passion," she muses.

Whether it's a tiny, intricate detail or a massive master-plan concept, for Sonali it is about finding something completely fresh to keep her mind energised. She wants every young architect to lead a life where every day is a discovery and where the most exciting place on earth for them to be is right inside their studio.